Daksh Vasudeva
Adobe NEXT Campus Leaders challenge

Release the Firefly

Make something. Find your people.

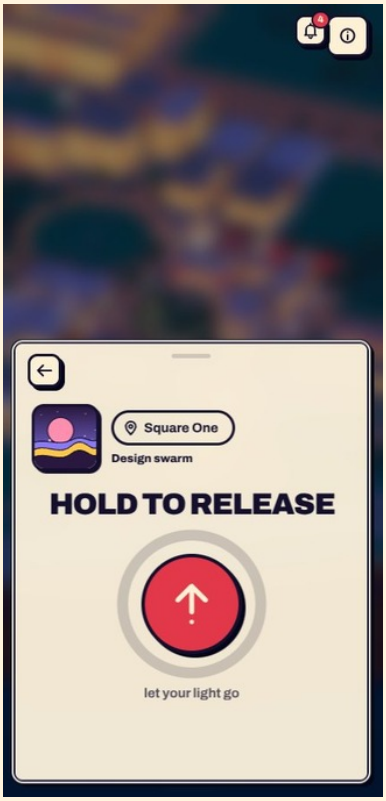
For two weeks, I want students at Chitkara to try Adobe Firefly, put what they make on our campus map and meet people they might not otherwise talk to.

I started with a gallery on a map, but sharing images alone didn't feel like enough. I wanted students to have someone to talk to, learn from and make things with. Workshops, open brainstorming sessions and the map would bring those parts together.

Open the app.



Make something. Meet someone.







Make something.

Make an image in Firefly and add it with the prompt you used. Pick a campus building and your school's swarm, or colour group. Hold Release, and your image becomes a firefly above that spot.

Give it a Glow.

Open a firefly to see who made it and how. If you like the work, give it a Glow. There are no dislikes, and nobody has to give a Glow back. It encourages people to keep making.

Meet someone new.

Each night at 9 PM, the campaign will offer groups of 3-5 students from different schools a public spot and time to meet. You can choose whether to join. Make one piece together, and it becomes a star on the map.

The board will rank Glows received, with one Glow per person per piece. It will show first names and totals. You can hide from the board, and who gave a Glow will stay private.

You can already try the demo without signing in. Your uploads and Glows stay in your browser. The people, totals, meetings and rewards shown are examples.

How I built it.

I wanted people from Chitkara to recognise the places they walk past every day. I photographed the campus and gave Claude the photos and maps. I kept checking the model and asking for changes to roads, entrances, buildings and lighting. Claude helped me build it in Three.js.



Picasso



Square One



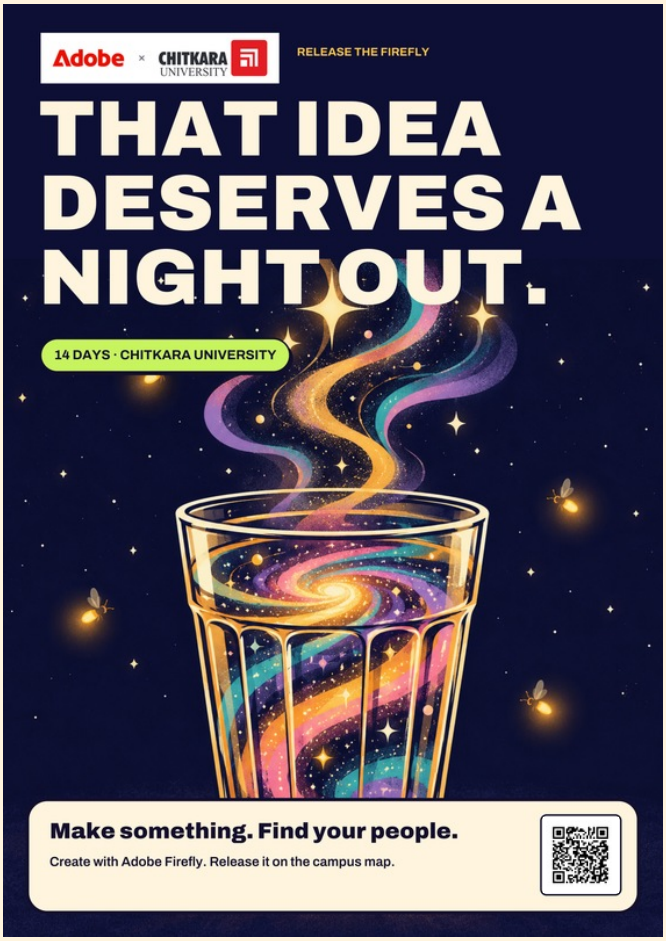


I used GPT to work on the icons and screen designs, then worked with Claude to put them into the map. I chose cream cards, dark outlines, Archivo type and warm colours for the app and campaign.

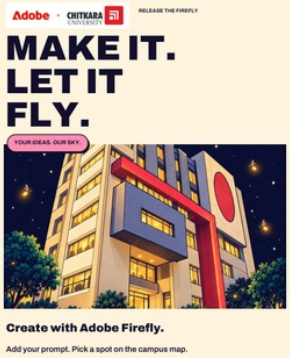
The final page shows the photographs, model, interface and motion studies together on my process board.

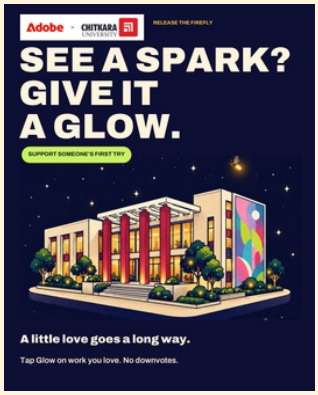
The campaign on campus.

I made three posters and four feed cards for places students already spend time, on campus and online. The four illustrations show a chai galaxy, Turing, Picasso and Square One. They are GPT concept art that I used to work out the look of the campaign.







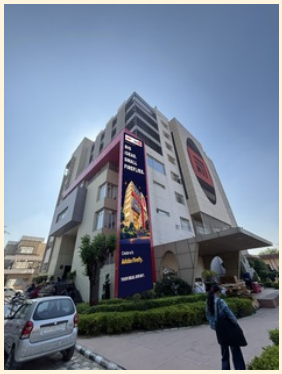




Open all posters and social artwork

These mockups show where the hoardings could go at Square One and Picasso. I would agree on their size and mounting with campus staff before putting them up.





Watch the campaign.

The longer film shows how the whole idea works. The 15-second cut is a quick invitation to try it. Both use the campus model, app screens and the same voiceover.



Watch the full campaign film

Watch the 15-second cut

I worked on the script, visuals and timing with AI assistance. The animation was made in Remotion, using the concept art and app screens. The voiceover uses the Christina voice from ElevenLabs.

The films were made in code. The brief also asks for a Firefly-made hero, a Firefly video and a Firefly Board link. I haven't produced those yet.

How I’ll run it.

I’ll run hands-on Firefly workshops and open talks. Students can sit with me and bring an idea or unfinished work. We’ll brainstorm, try better prompts and look at composition, colour and typography. I’ll use what I’ve learnt in communication design to help them improve their work, with time for questions and feedback.

Days 1-3	I’ll put QR posters at Square One, the library, school entrances and hostel noticeboards. The first workshops will introduce Firefly and help students make their first image.
Days 4-7	I’ll share student work with permission and explain Glow. At 9 PM, hosts will help groups meet at public campus spots and make one small piece together.
Days 8-13	I’ll keep the talks and feedback sessions open, share group work and print corridor posters. I’ll invite students from schools with fewer participants and collect permission for the projection and zine.
Day 14	I’ll hold Swarm Night and project the top ten by Glows received alongside group work. New releases and Glows will close, while the final board and an archive of work shared with permission will stay online.

Students can earn rewards.

Spark, Glow, Lantern and Beacon will show progress. I’m proposing story cards, corridor posters, glow pins, a projection, a zine, certificates and portfolio reviews. Any Adobe perks will stay tentative.

Students will keep credit for their work.

Students will use their own images, or images they have permission to use. Each artwork will show its prompt so others can learn how it was made. I’ll get permission before publishing names or work, and keep meetings optional and public. I’ll count how many students make their first image, which schools take part, how many return and how many group pieces they make.

Release the Firefly

Daksh / Chitkara

Adobe × CHITKARA UNIVERSITY

I started with a campus gallery.

I wanted students to recognise their own campus.

I wanted students to meet through the things they make.

Students make something, give Glows and meet.



The campus map



Picasso



Square One

I checked the roads against the map and corrected their spacing.

I asked Claude to build an interactive 3D campus.



The creeper walkway



Newton

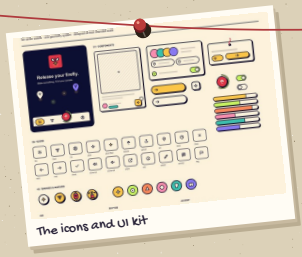


Edison

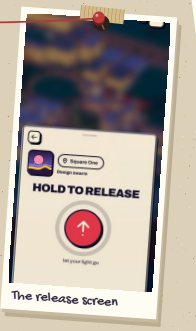
I used my photos to direct Claude.



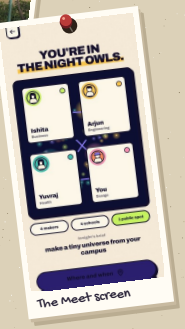
The campus model, built in Three.js



The icons and UI kit



The release screen



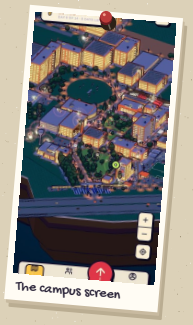
The Meet screen

I kept the red building details and made the windows glow.



Fleming

I adjusted the entrances and road spacing.



The campus screen

I replaced extra instructions with simple taps.

I made four art studies with GPT.



chai galaxy

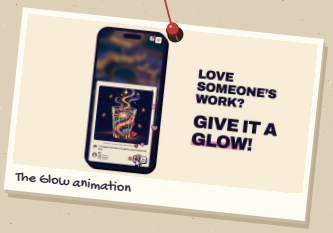


Turing

These four images are GPT concept art.



The release animation



The Glow animation

The board counts Glows received. The giver stays private.



Picasso



Square One



The 9 PM match

I recorded the voiceover first, then timed the animation to it.

I used ElevenLabs for the voiceover.

The demo opens without signing in. Try it on your phone.

Open the app